

GoOutside — Market Strategy, Competitive Positioning & Macroeconomic Analysis

Date: 2026-06-17

Question: In a world where Accra runs on TikTok and Instagram to find events — where does GoOutside fit? Can we steal the market? What's the play?

1. The Honest Reality Check — What TikTok & Instagram Actually Do

Before we talk about stealing the market, we need to be ruthlessly honest about what the incumbents do well and where they fall apart.

Instagram

What it does well:

- Beautiful visual discovery — a club posts a reel, it spreads
- DM-based event sharing ("you coming to this?")
- Stories for "tonight only" urgency
- Organizer followership — fans follow their favorite promoter

Where it completely fails:

- Zero structured event data — everything is buried in a caption
- No ticketing, no RSVPs, no confirmation
- No personalization based on actual interests — you see what the algorithm decides
- No memory — an event post from 3 weeks ago is dead and unfindable
- No reviews, no Pulse, no accountability for bad events
- No going-out intent signal — your feed is also fashion, food, family, memes
- Discovery is passive: you see what you follow, not what exists

TikTok

What it does well:

- Viral discovery — a great party video reaches people who've never heard of the organizer
- Trend amplification — a single clip can make a new venue famous overnight
- Younger audience discovery ("I found this spot on TikTok")
- Raw, authentic content over polished ads

Where it completely fails:

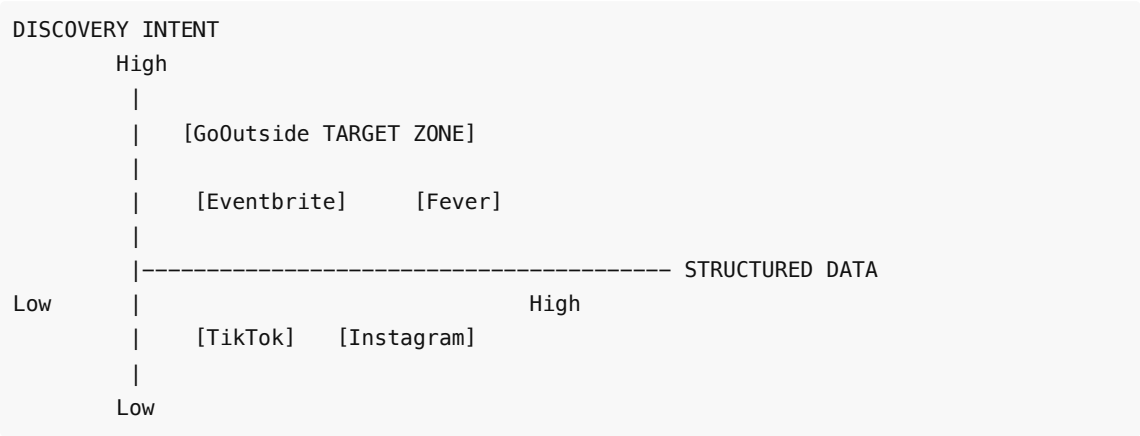
- Zero transactional capability — you see the party, then go find tickets somewhere else (Eventbrite, WhatsApp, DM)
- Completely ephemeral — the video dies, the event is unfindable a week later
- No location-aware curation — TikTok shows you Lagos events when you're in Kumasi
- No community or social graph tied to going-out — your TikTok followers are not your Accra crew
- No intent capture — watching a party video is not the same as wanting to go out

The Gap Both Leave Open

Neither platform answers the question: **"What is happening in Accra this weekend that is right for ME, and how do I go?"**

That gap is GoOutside's entire reason to exist.

2. The Real Competitive Landscape Map



GoOutside competes in the **high-intent + high-structure** quadrant. TikTok and Instagram are in the **low-intent + low-structure** quadrant. They are not the same product. This is the reframe.

You don't go to Instagram to *find* an event. You stumble on it.
You don't go to TikTok to *plan* your weekend. You waste time on it.
You go to GoOutside **because you want to go out** — and that intent difference is everything.

3. The TripAdvisor Comparison — Is This Real?

TripAdvisor became the dominant travel review platform not by outspending airlines or hotels on marketing, but by doing one thing: **becoming the place where intent meets structured information.**

When someone is about to book a trip, they don't go to Instagram to find a hotel. They go to TripAdvisor because it gives them structured, comparative, trustworthy information.

GoOutside's play is identical for the **going-out vertical in West Africa.**

TripAdvisor	GoOutside
Hotel/Restaurant reviews	Event/Venue reviews
Star ratings	Pulse scores
"Best restaurants in Bangkok"	"Best events in Accra this weekend"
Traveller photos	Attendee snippets + check-ins
User-generated trust signals	Community Pulse ratings
Hotel booking	Ticket purchase
City guides	Vibe-matched city feed
Global but locally deep	West Africa-first, then global diaspora

The TripAdvisor thesis for GoOutside:

When someone in Accra is about to make a decision about where to go out, they will eventually reach for GoOutside the same way a tourist reaches for TripAdvisor before booking a restaurant. The goal is to be the **default going-out decision layer** — the thing you check before you go.

TripAdvisor took 10 years to build that reflex. GoOutside is going after it in a market where NO structured going-out platform exists yet. The land is unclaimed.

4. GoOutside's Actual USP — The Stack

Not one USP. A stack of reinforcing advantages that are very hard to replicate together.

USP 1: Going-Out Intent as the Starting Point

Everyone on GoOutside is there because they want to go out. Not to post photos, not to watch videos, not to stay in touch with family. Pure intent. This makes every user more valuable than 1,000 passive TikTok scrollers.

USP 2: The Social Graph is Built Around Going Out

On Instagram, your graph is built around who you find interesting. On GoOutside, your graph is built around who you actually go out with. Your Accra crew. Your vibe tribe. This makes recommendations viral in the right way — "your people are going to this."

USP 3: Pulse Score = Reputation Layer Nobody Else Has

No platform in West Africa has a going-out reputation score. Your Pulse score is your going-out identity. High Pulse = tastemaker = social status. This is deeply gameable in a good way — users are incentivized to attend more events, leave reviews, invite friends, check in. TikTok cannot build this. Instagram cannot build this. It takes years of behavioral data to construct and becomes a moat over time.

USP 4: The Full Stack (Discovery → Ticket → Check-in → Memory)

Instagram covers discovery. WhatsApp covers ticket sharing. Paystack covers payment. Photos go back on Instagram. There are 4 different apps for one night out. GoOutside collapses all of that into one flow:

```
Discover event → See friends going → Buy ticket → Get QR → Check in → Earn Pulse →  
Post snippet → Review → Get recommended similar events → repeat
```

Every step in one app. That's a flywheel. Once it spins, the data compounds and makes every next recommendation better.

USP 5: West Africa First = Home Court Advantage

Eventbrite is built for the US/UK. Fever is built for global metros. Neither understands:

- GHS payment (Paystack is Ghanaian)
- Neighborhood context (Osu vs East Legon vs Tema mean very different things)
- Event culture (highlife nights, Afrobeats, detty December, University events)
- The way Accra plans (very last-minute, very WhatsApp-driven, very word-of-mouth)
- Mobile-first (data-light, fast-loading, offline grace)

GoOutside is built by people who understand this from the inside. That cultural fluency cannot be bought by a Silicon Valley competitor parachuting in.

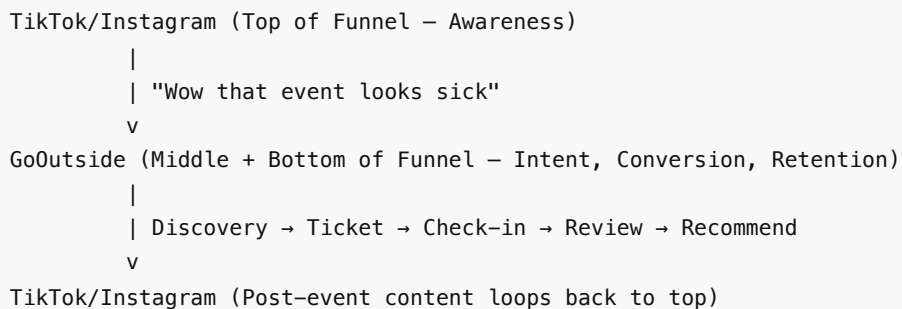
USP 6: Venue Layer (Nobody Has This in Ghana)

No structured venue directory exists for Accra. Not one. Google Maps has inaccurate hours, dead listings, no vibe data. GoOutside's venue layer will be the first time someone can open an app and see: "What's open in Osu right now that matches my vibe?"

5. The Strategy — How GoOutside Fuses These Mediums

The answer is NOT to fight TikTok and Instagram. The answer is to make GoOutside the destination that TikTok and Instagram feed into.

The Funnel Flip



TikTok and Instagram become GoOutside's free marketing channels. GoOutside becomes the place where that interest converts to action.

Tactical Plays to Fuse the Mediums

Play 1: "Find on TikTok, Buy on GoOutside"

- Every event on GoOutside gets a shareable link with a preview card (OG tags, event cover, date, vibe).
- Organizer posts their TikTok/Instagram reel, drops the GoOutside link in bio.
- User lands on the event page, buys ticket, joins the going-list.
- GoOutside tracks the referral source. Data compound.

Play 2: GoOutside Snippets → Fuel TikTok Content

- After an event, attendees post 30-second Snippets inside GoOutside (already in the vision).
- GoOutside auto-exports a "My Night" highlight reel formatted for TikTok/Instagram Stories.
- Every shared clip is watermarked with the GoOutside logo + event page link.
- Users become organic distributors. Every post is an ad.

Play 3: The Weekend Wrap Card (Viral)

- Every Monday, GoOutside generates a shareable card: "Your Weekend Score — 2 events, 340 Pulse Points, Tastemaker rank #47 in Accra."
- Users share this on Instagram Stories the way people share Spotify Wrapped.
- This is free social proof and brand awareness at massive scale.

Play 4: The TikTok Creator Program

- Partner with Accra content creators and nightlife TikTok accounts.
- Give them verified GoOutside Creator status + a revenue share on ticket sales driven by their link.

- They become GoOutside affiliates without knowing it. Their audience becomes GoOutside's pipeline.

Play 5: Instagram Bio Link Ownership

- GoOutside gives every organizer a `gooutside.app/[username]` link that replaces Linktree in their Instagram bio.
- It's a live page that always shows their upcoming events, ticket links, and follower count on GoOutside.
- Organizers promote it because it makes them look professional. GoOutside gets distribution.

6. How GoOutside Stays Prime and Center — The Habit Loop

Apps that win don't win on features. They win by building a **daily habit loop**. Here's GoOutside's:

TRIGGER → ACTION → REWARD → INVESTMENT

Thursday night (going-out planning time) →	Open GoOutside to browse the weekend feed →	See what's happening that matches your vibe →
Book tickets, tell friends going →	Share with your crew on WhatsApp/IG →	Earn Pulse Points, unlock new rank →
	Post snippet Sunday → Your review helps the algorithm → Better recommendations next week	↻ loop

Each loop makes the next loop more personalized and more valuable. After 3 months of this, your GoOutside feed knows you better than any human concierge. That's when churn becomes nearly impossible.

Non-negotiable habit triggers to build:

- Thursday push notification: "Your weekend lineup — 5 events matching your vibe"
- Friday lunchtime: "Friends of yours are going to [Event] tonight"
- Sunday evening: "Rate last night — earn 50 Pulse Points"
- Monday: "Your weekend score is ready" (shareable card)

7. Macroeconomic Context — Why NOW Is the Right Time

Ghana's Going-Out Economy

- Ghana's entertainment and nightlife economy is estimated at over \$500M USD annually (informal estimate; no formal research exists, which itself is an opportunity).
- Dettty December alone — the annual influx of diaspora to Accra — generates hundreds of millions in ticket sales, venue revenue, hospitality, and fashion.
- The Accra party and events circuit has gone from informal to semi-professional in the last 5 years. Promoters now run full businesses.
- Mobile money penetration: Ghana has one of the highest mobile money adoption rates in Africa (MoMo, Hubtel). Payment infrastructure is ready.

- Smartphone penetration: 45%+ in Ghana and rising sharply in urban centers.
- Youth bulge: 57% of Ghana's population is under 25. This is GoOutside's core demographic for the next 20 years.

Africa's Creator Economy Tailwind

- The creator economy in Africa is growing faster than any other region.
- Event promotion has become a legitimate profession in Accra, Lagos, Nairobi — but these creators have no proper tooling.
- GoOutside gives professional infrastructure to this emerging class.

Diaspora Market — The Hidden Multiplier

- Ghanaian diaspora in UK, US, Canada, Germany collectively spend enormous amounts on trips back for events (Afronation, BHIM Concert, Detty December).
- They plan months in advance, from abroad, on their phones.
- GoOutside's digital-first model captures this diaspora planning intent that Instagram and local flyers can never reach.
- Future feature: "Detty December Mode" — diaspora planning dashboard. Book events months before landing.

The Eventbrite Gap in Africa

- Eventbrite has minimal Africa presence and no cultural investment.
- Fever has zero West Africa presence.
- Dice FM (UK-focused) has not expanded to Africa.
- The market is genuinely open. First-mover advantage in tech is massively valuable when no incumbent exists.

Economic Resilience

- Entertainment is one of the most recession-resilient categories.
- During economic hardship, people still go out — they choose cheaper events, but going-out social behavior persists.
- Ghana has had currency pressures (cedi depreciation), but urban youth entertainment spending has stayed robust.
- GoOutside's tiered pricing (free discovery, paid premium, subscription) is structured to weather economic cycles.

8. Competitive Moat — What Protects GoOutside Long-Term

Moats that compound over time:

Data Moat (Most Important)

Every event attended, every check-in, every Pulse score, every snippet, every search — this behavioral dataset about going-out preferences in West Africa does not exist anywhere else. After 2 years, GoOutside's recommendation engine will be trained on more Ghanaian going-out behavior than any competitor could replicate from scratch. This is the single most defensible asset.

Network Effect Moat

Going out is inherently social. The more of your friends are on GoOutside, the more valuable it is to you. This is a classic social network effect — it compounds non-linearly. Getting the first 10,000 Accra users into the habit loop is the hardest part. After that, social pressure recruits the next 100,000.

Supply-Side Lock-in (Organizers & Venues)

Once an organizer builds their following on GoOutside, posts their events there, uses the analytics dashboard, and gets revenue from GoOutside-driven ticket sales — they won't leave. The cost of switching is too high. Same for venues. This is supply-side lock-in identical to how Airbnb captured hosts or Uber captured drivers.

Reputation Moat (Pulse Scores)

After 2 years of using GoOutside, your Pulse score is your social identity in Accra's going-out scene. You will not abandon a platform that holds your identity. This is the same reason people don't leave Uber (their 4.9 star rating) or LinkedIn (their professional history).

Brand Moat (First-Mover Cultural Credibility)

In culture-driven markets, the first brand to own a category owns it. "Google it." "Uber there." "Check GoOutside." Becoming the verb is the goal. You achieve it by being first, being consistent, and being culturally authentic. A US company cannot parachute in and replicate that in Accra. They'll always feel foreign.

9. The Scenarios — How This Can Go

Best Case: Category Creator

GoOutside defines the "going-out app" category in West Africa the way Spotify defined music streaming. Reaches 500K MAU across Ghana, Nigeria, Kenya within 3 years. Becomes the infrastructure layer for events — organizers, venues, diaspora, tourists all use it as default. Raises Series A on the strength of data and GMV through the platform.

Middle Case: Dominant in Ghana, Niche Elsewhere

GoOutside becomes the definitive Accra/Ghana going-out platform. Doesn't fully expand but builds a deeply loyal, highly engaged user base of 100–200K MAU. Revenue is strong from subscriptions (venue + organizer) + ticket commissions. Acquired by a media company, travel company, or regional super-app.

Risk Case: Instagram Wins the Inertia Battle

Users discover events on Instagram, buy tickets via WhatsApp DM, and never adopt a dedicated app. GoOutside stays a tool used only by power users and organizers. Mitigation: lean into the B2B (organizer + venue) subscription revenue — even if consumers don't come, the B2B layer pays the bills.

10. The Plays — Ranked by Impact

Play	Impact	Difficulty	When
Organizer-first strategy — make promoters evangelists	Very High	Medium	Now
Detty December 2026 push — diaspora marketing blitz	Very High	Medium	Q4 2026
TikTok creator affiliate program	High	Low	Q3 2026
"Find on TikTok/IG, buy on GoOutside" link campaign	High	Low	Now

Weekend Score shareable card (viral loop)	High	Low	Q3 2026
Venue layer launch — structured directory	High	Medium	Q3 2026
University campus activation (KNUST, UG, Ashesi)	Very High	Low	Q3 2026
Diaspora planning dashboard	Medium	Medium	Q4 2026
Leaderboard + Pulse rank public page	Medium	Low	Q3 2026
Event group chat (community within events)	Medium	Medium	Q4 2026

11. The One-Paragraph Positioning Statement

GoOutside is West Africa's going-out intelligence layer.
TikTok shows you a party. Instagram shows you photos from it. GoOutside tells you what's happening this weekend that matches your vibe, connects you with your crew, gets you in the door, remembers what you loved, and gets you back out again. We don't compete with social media — we're where social media sends you when you're actually ready to go.

12. What GoOutside Is Playing For Long-Term

- Year 1:** Own the Accra going-out habit. 50K MAU, 500 organizers, 200 venues.
- Year 2:** Expand to Lagos and Nairobi. 300K MAU. Series A.
- Year 3:** Diaspora dashboard, travel integration, B2B API for venues/hotels. 1M MAU.
- Year 5:** The TripAdvisor of African nightlife and events. The default infrastructure layer. Acquisition target or IPO candidate.

The question is not whether this market exists. It clearly does — billions of GHS move through it every year. The question is who builds the infrastructure first. That's GoOutside's race to run.